RRSP + Spousal RRSP Multi-Brokerage Tracker: User Guide

Every tab, every column and every menu item, in plain English

The tracker is built around one idea: you type each transaction once, in the Transaction Log, and every other tab updates by itself. The only other place you type is the amber cells on Settings & Goals. Everything green is a formula: leave it alone and it will always be right. Throughout the sheet, "you" are the contributor (the person who pays into both accounts and claims the deduction) and "your spouse" is the owner of the spousal RRSP.

Colour	Meaning
Amber	Your input. Type here (Settings & Goals).
Blue	A dropdown. Pick from the list (Institution, Account, Type, Currency).
White	Manual entry in the Transaction Log (date, ticker, shares, price, amount).
Green	A formula. Do not type here.
Navy / Purple / Teal	Your RRSP / the spousal RRSP / both together, on every tab.

Your template link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1cpGIzurh8Qcbd3vXg94FCnt1VIU9Se-1aQug-w6FNYQ/copy (opens Make a copy).

THE MAPLESHEET MENU

Menu item	What it does
Build / Rebuild All Tabs	Builds every tab. Safe to run again: it keeps your Settings inputs and Transaction Log rows.
Load Sample Data	Fills the Transaction Log with a sample couple: your RRSP at Questrade and RBC, the spousal RRSP at Wealthsimple, Questrade and TD, including a spousal withdrawal that is taxed back. Replaces anything in the log.
Clear Sample Data	Empties the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns and Settings stay.
Rebuild Dashboard Charts	Redraws the charts if one goes blank.
About	Shows the version.

First time you use the menu. Google shows an "Authorization required" box. Click Continue, choose your Google account, then Advanced and Allow. The script only works inside your own copy of the sheet.

1. SETTINGS & GOALS: SET UP ONCE, UPDATE EACH JANUARY

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B5 to B8	Your name, your spouse's name, province and Active Year.	Change B8 every January.
B9 to B10	Your birth year and your spouse's.	B11 and B12 show when each RRSP must become a RRIF.
B16 to B23	Up to 8 institutions where either RRSP is held. Leave a slot blank to hide it.	Use exactly the same name every time.
B26	"RRSP deduction limit" from YOUR latest Notice of Assessment.	Already includes carry-forward room.

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B27	"Unused RRSP contributions" from the same NOA (often $0).	B28 = B26 – B27 is the room both accounts share.
B29	The $2,000 lifetime over-contribution buffer.	Leave it unless CRA changes it.
B39 to B40	Automatic: your last spousal contribution year and the date every withdrawal is safe.	From the Transaction Log.
B47 to B50	Your RRSP goal, spousal RRSP goal, dividend goal and household goal.	Your own plan.
B53 to B54	Default currency and an optional USD/CAD rate.	Leave B54 blank to use the live rate.

The grey cells are a quick reference (deadline, withholding, the treaty, the Home Buyers' Plan, the 3-year rule and its exceptions). At the bottom are two checklists, one for December and one for January.

2. TRANSACTION LOG: THE ONLY TAB YOU TYPE INTO

One row per transaction, starting on row 4. Never delete old rows: your ACB, room and attribution numbers depend on the full history. **Already own investments?** Log each holding once as a Buy, with column L = what you paid for it. Log every spousal contribution from the last 3 calendar years with its real date, and this year's contributions to your own RRSP.

Col	Column	What to enter
A	Date	The trade or deposit date (yyyy-mm-dd). For spousal contributions the year matters: it starts the 3-year clock.
B	Year	Automatic.
C	Institution	Dropdown from Settings B16:B23.
D	Account	**RRSP (yours) or Spousal RRSP. Pick it on every row.** It decides which portfolio the row counts in, and spousal contributions feed the Attribution Tracker.
E	Type	Dropdown, see the table below.
F	Ticker	Canadian: with the prefix (TSE:XEQT, TSE:RY). US: with or without (KO or NYSE:KO). Blank for contributions.
G	Description	Anything that helps you remember.
H	Currency	CAD or USD. This (not the ticker) decides whether prices are converted to CAD.
I	Shares / Units	For Buy, Sell, DRIP and transfers of shares.
J	Price / Share	For Buy, Sell and DRIP.
K	Commission	Optional.
L	Amt (Original)	The total in the original currency (for a Buy: shares × price + commission).
M	FX Rate	Automatic: 1 for CAD, live USD/CAD (or your override) for USD.
N	Amt (CAD)	Automatic. Every dashboard adds up this column.
O	Check	Automatic. Shows ✓, or what is missing (institution, account, ticker, shares, amount).

Type	Use it for
Contribution	Money you put into either RRSP. Both use YOUR room. Spousal ones also start the 3-year clock.
Withdrawal	Money taken out. From the spousal RRSP, the tracker checks it against the 3-year rule.
Buy / Sell	Shares, price and commission, plus the total in column L.
Dividend	Cash dividend: log what arrived in the account (US-listed dividends arrive in full in an RRSP).

Type	Use it for
DRIP	A dividend reinvested in new shares: enter the shares, the price and the amount.
Fee	Account or admin fees.
Transfer Out / Transfer In	A direct transfer between two institutions for the SAME account (your RRSP to your RRSP, or spousal to spousal). Log both sides. It is not a contribution and uses no room. Never use it between your RRSP and the spousal RRSP.

3. MAIN DASHBOARD

Section	What it shows
3 big cards	Your RRSP, the spousal RRSP and the household total, each with the gain vs cost.
Institution cards	One column per brokerage plus All Institutions: value of each RRSP, total, gain/loss, contributions to each account in the room window and dividends this year.
Attribution block	Spousal contributions paid this year, last year and 2 years ago, the amount at risk, spousal withdrawals this year and the part taxed back to you, with a message line.
RRSP room block	Your deduction limit, unused contributions, available room, contributions to EACH account from March 2 to March 1, and the room left. Over-contributions within the $2,000 lifetime buffer get a softer warning.
Right column	Last 5 transactions, income this year (each account, average, full-year estimate) and progress bars for both contribution goals and the household goal.
Charts	Market value by institution (both RRSPs stacked), monthly dividend income, and My RRSP vs Spousal RRSP vs the household total with the difference between them.

Why the room uses March 2 to March 1, but the 3-year rule uses calendar years. Contributions made in the first 60 days of a year can be deducted on the previous year's return, so your room for 2026 covers March 2, 2026 to March 1, 2027. The attribution rule ignores that: it only looks at the calendar year you paid the contribution. A spousal contribution on February 15, 2027 uses 2026 room but counts as a 2027 contribution for the 3-year rule.

4. MY RRSP PORTFOLIO AND SPOUSAL RRSP PORTFOLIO

Every stock and ETF in that account, all institutions combined: currency (detected from your Transaction Log), shares, average cost in CAD, cost basis, live price in CAD, market value, gain/loss, return % (gain ÷ cost) and all-time dividends. Shares = buys + DRIP + transfers in – sells – transfers out.

5. INSTITUTION DASHBOARD

Up to 8 brokerages side by side: each RRSP's market value and cost, the total, gain/loss, contributions to each account and dividends, with the attribution and room blocks underneath. On the right, a donut chart and table show what share of your two RRSPs is at each brokerage.

6. ATTRIBUTION TRACKER

Section	What it shows
Cards	At risk this year, taxed back to you this year, the last spousal contribution year, the date every contribution is safe, the spousal share of your two RRSPs, and the year the spousal RRSP must convert.
A: every year	From 2 years before the Active Year (the oldest year that can still be at risk) to 7 years ahead: spousal contributions paid, the date each year becomes safe, its status (SAFE or AT RISK), spousal withdrawals that year, and how much was taxed back to you or to your spouse.
B: by institution	The spousal RRSP value at each brokerage and the at-risk contributions paid there this year, last year and 2 years ago.
C: household balance	Both RRSPs, the spousal share, and the amount that would make the split 50 / 50.
D: how the rule works	Six reminders, with the safe date for this year's contributions.

How "taxed back to you" is worked out. For a year with spousal withdrawals, the tracker takes the smaller of the withdrawals and the spousal contributions you paid that year and the two before it. That is the amount Form T2205 puts on your return. It does not know about the exceptions (HBP and LLP withdrawals, the RRIF minimum, separation, death, non-residence): if one applies to you, nothing is taxed back.

7. DIVIDEND TRACKER

Eight cards (all-time income, income in each RRSP this year, DRIP, monthly average, full-year estimate, goal and progress), a US withholding line, Section A month by month against your monthly target, Section B every dividend and DRIP with its institution and account, and Section C a per-ticker summary with an annual run rate. In both RRSPs, US-listed dividends arrive with 0% US tax thanks to the Canada-US treaty; the line shows the 15% you would have lost in a TFSA or taxable account.

8. SPOUSAL RRSP CRA RULES

The rules that matter when you pay into two RRSPs at more than one institution, as colour-coded cards: red for costly mistakes, amber for limits and deadlines, green for benefits. The Government Rules PDF explains each one in more detail.

EVERY JANUARY

1. **Make a copy (optional)**
   File, Make a copy, named for the new year. Or keep one file: the log holds all history.
2. **Change the Active Year**
   Settings B8, for example 2026 to 2027. Room, attribution and "this year" numbers all switch.
3. **Update your RRSP numbers**
   B26 and B27 from your new Notice of Assessment, usually in the spring after you file.
4. **Check the Attribution Tracker**
   The oldest at-risk year becomes SAFE on January 1.
5. **Keep logging**
   Add new transactions below the old ones. Holdings, ACB and the attribution history carry forward.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem	Fix
A price shows $0.00	Canadian tickers need TSE: (TSE:XEQT). NEO: for Cboe Canada. GOOGLEFINANCE can also pause for a few minutes.
A US stock's value looks too low	Its Buy rows must have Currency = USD so the price is converted to CAD.
A transaction is missing from a dashboard	Look at column O. The Institution must match Settings exactly, the Account and Type must be picked, and the date must be a real date.
RRSP room looks wrong	B26 is the NOA deduction limit (do not add carry-forward). January and February contributions count for last year. Contributions to both accounts are counted.
Attribution looks wrong	Spousal contributions must have Account = Spousal RRSP and the date they were actually paid.
"This year" numbers are $0	Settings B8 (Active Year) does not match the year of your transactions.
A chart is blank	MapleSheet menu, Rebuild Dashboard Charts.
Something broke	MapleSheet menu, Build / Rebuild All Tabs. Your inputs and transactions are kept.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Rules summarized for 2026 from canada.ca. Always confirm your own room on your Notice of Assessment. Questions: hello@maplesheet.ca